

Virginia Ventures: Course Assessment

Name: MODEL RESPONSE

Part 1: Founder's Outline

Instructions: Plan your business by filling in every box.

<u>Part of the Plan</u>	<u>Your Answer</u>
Business Name	Homegrown Helpers
The Problem You're Solving (What problem is it, and who experiences it?)	In my neighborhood, the closest store with fresh vegetables is kind of far, and some of my neighbors don't drive. People near me want fresh vegetables, but they have a hard time getting them.
Idea (What does your business actually do?)	I'll grow vegetables in my own backyard and sell them to my neighbors. I will also give some of my vegetables to local food pantries: for every ten boxes of vegetables I sell, I will donate one.
Customers (Who will use or buy what I am offering?)	My neighbors on my street who want fresh food and like helping the community.
What will I need to start? (Name your natural, human, and capital resources)	Natural resources are the soil, sun, and water I need to grow my vegetables. Human resources are me and my little sister who wants to help. Capital resources are seeds, a shovel, a watering can, and boxes to pack the vegetables in.
How you'll make money (How will your business earn enough to keep going?)	I'll sell each box for a price that covers what I spend on seeds and boxes, with a little extra. That

	extra is my profit and I will save some of it to buy more seeds.
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Part 2: Lessons from History

Instructions: Pick one economic lesson from each of the three eras and write 3-5 sentences per lesson, describing how it shaped a choice you have made for your business. Reminder: each lesson needs to connect to a real choice you made in Part 1.

Colonial Trade Era (Modules 2-3):

When I was a merchant, I learned about supply and demand. People will pay for something they want but cannot get easily. My neighbors want fresh vegetables but have a hard time getting them, so there is demand. I need to grow the vegetables that people are interested in.

Farms and Factories Era (Modules 4-5):

In the Market Harvest game, I learned that farming has a lot of risk because of the weather. One bad storm can destroy my vegetables. I will grow a few different vegetables at the same time, so that if one of them doesn't grow well, I will still have the others to sell.

Modern Virginia (Modules 6-9):

In the Boss for a Day game, I learned that keeping your customers happy is necessary for success. If people are happy, they will come back to buy more vegetables. So, I will always be friendly and ask my customers which vegetables they liked the most so I can make sure I grow those.

Part 3: The Pitch

Instructions: Write a short (5-7 sentences) pitch that convinces someone that your business is a great idea. A strong pitch tells someone what problem your business helps to solve, what makes your idea special, and why it will work. Somewhere in your pitch, be sure to name at least one lesson from history that makes your business smart.

Have you ever wanted fresh vegetables but the store was too far? That's the problem that Homegrown Helpers solves. I grow fresh vegetables right in my own backyard and deliver them to my neighbors, so fresh food is close by. And for every ten boxes I sell, I will give one to our local food pantry, so that families in need also have access to fresh foods.

I know Homegrown Helpers will work because of something I learned in class. Farming has risk, so instead of growing a lot of just one plant, I will grow a few different vegetables. If one crop has a bad week, I will still have the other crops to sell.

Fresh food, fair prices, and giving back is the mission of Homegrown Helpers, and I would love for you to be part of it.